

VIKRAM BHANWALA

Website & Technology Head | Full Stack Developer (Node.js | PHP | Shopify | WordPress)

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linkedin.com/in/vikrambhanwala | Timezone: IST (GMT+5:30) — flexible for US/UK/EU overlap

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technology leader and full-stack developer with 5+ years of experience spanning hands-on engineering, team leadership, and technical ownership of website and product platforms. Currently heading Website & Technology at Brand Bee, leading a team of 5+ developers while driving architecture decisions, client-facing solutioning, and delivery of 9+ live client platforms across custom Shopify, custom WordPress, and full-stack Node.js/PHP applications. Experienced in integrating AI capabilities (OpenAI API, Anthropic Claude API) into products and workflows to improve automation and efficiency. Skilled at translating client requirements into scalable technical architecture, mentoring engineers, planning sprints, and managing cross-functional collaboration between business stakeholders and engineering teams. Strong background in RESTful API design, microservices, AWS cloud infrastructure, database optimization, and performance tuning using Redis and caching strategies. Comfortable working across time zones and collaborating with distributed, international teams.

CORE TECHNICAL & LEADERSHIP SKILLS

Team Leadership & Management: Team leadership, hiring & onboarding, 1:1s & performance reviews, sprint planning & agile ceremonies, code reviews, mentoring & upskilling developers, resource allocation, technical roadmap & project planning

Client Handling: Client requirement gathering, solution architecting, technical consulting, stakeholder communication, delivery ownership

Backend Development: Node.js, PHP (Core PHP, CodeIgniter), Express.js

Frontend Development: JavaScript, React, Next.js (frontend & backend), AJAX

eCommerce & CMS: Custom Shopify development, custom WordPress development & plugins, WooCommerce

API Development: REST APIs, Microservices Architecture, API Security, third-party & payment gateway integrations

AI & Developer Productivity Tools: OpenAI API (GPT models), Anthropic Claude API, Cursor AI, GitHub Copilot, LLM integration, prompt engineering, AI-powered chatbots & automation, AI-assisted coding & code review workflows

Databases: MySQL, MongoDB, AWS RDS

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS EC2, Linux Servers, cPanel, Plesk

Performance Optimization: Redis, Query Optimization, Caching strategies

Tools & Practices: Git, GitHub, GitLab, Jira, MVC Architecture

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Website & Technology Head | Brand Bee

05 Sept 2022 – Present

- Lead the website and technology function end-to-end, owning architecture, delivery, and technical strategy for all client web platforms.
- Lead and manage a team of 5+ developers — hiring, onboarding, task allocation, code reviews, 1:1s, and performance mentoring.
- Handle client relationships directly — gathering requirements, architecting solutions, and translating business needs into scalable technical roadmaps.
- Drive adoption of AI-powered development tools including Cursor AI, GitHub Copilot, and the OpenAI/Claude APIs to speed up coding, automate reviews, and boost team productivity.
- Architected and delivered 9+ live client platforms — including custom Shopify storefronts and custom WordPress builds — tailored to each client's business requirements.
- Designed and engineered scalable backend services using Node.js, PHP (including CodeIgniter), and Express.js.
- Implemented RESTful APIs using MVC and microservice architecture, and delivered full-stack applications using Next.js for both frontend and backend.
- Integrated 3 major payment gateways (Razorpay, Stripe, PhonePe) across client platforms, enabling secure and flexible checkout options.

- Managed AWS EC2 infrastructure and AWS RDS databases, ensuring platform reliability and uptime.
- Improved system performance using Redis caching and database query optimization.
- Guided the team on technology stack decisions, coding best practices, and project delivery timelines.

Backend Developer | Weaddo

Jan 2022 – Sep 2022

- Engineered backend services powering React and Next.js applications.
- Created PHP MVC applications and REST API integrations.
- Consolidated multiple data sources into unified backend services.
- Maintained application performance and database reliability.

PHP Developer | Healthians

Aug 2020 – Jan 2022

- Built REST APIs for internal services and third-party integrations, supporting multiple business units.
- Set up CMS modules using PHP MVC frameworks.
- Created custom WordPress themes, plugins, and dynamic web applications using Core PHP and MySQL.
- Integrated third-party APIs and managed application deployments.
- Improved backend stability and system performance.

KEY WEBSITES & PLATFORMS DELIVERED

- Hero Cycles (herocycles.com) — Custom Shopify eCommerce platform for India's largest bicycle manufacturer, covering kids, teens, and accessories catalogs.
- Home & Kraft (homeandkraft.com) — Custom Shopify D2C storefront for handmade, made-to-measure rugs, serving customers across the US, UK, and Canada.
- Fiorella India (fiorellaindia.com) — Custom eCommerce platform for online flower and gifting delivery.
- Sheela Foam (sheelafoam.com) — Corporate website for Sheela Foam Ltd, an NSE-listed manufacturer and parent of Sleepwell, Kurl-On, and Furlenco.
- ICRA Analytics (icraanalytics.com) — Platform website for ICRA's data & analytics arm, covering credit risk, ESG, and mutual fund research offerings.
- Fundeddd (fundeddd.com) — Corporate website for a fintech company offering invoice factoring and payroll funding solutions for staffing businesses.
- MNB Buildfab (mnbbuildfab.com) — Corporate website for a real estate development company with projects across Delhi NCR, Mumbai, Gujarat, and Goa.
- NuStock Images (nustockimages.com) — Custom stock photography and media licensing marketplace platform.
- The Brand Bee (thebrandbee.com) — Corporate/agency website for Brand Bee.

EDUCATION

M.Sc. Computer Science | Maharishi Dayanand University | 2018 – 2020

ADDITIONAL STRENGTHS

- Proven team leadership — hiring, mentoring, and managing developer performance
- Hands-on with AI development tools (Cursor AI, GitHub Copilot, OpenAI API, Claude API) to boost team productivity
- Clean code architecture and maintainable backend design
- End-to-end development ownership from architecture to deployment